



family. As a child, the only thing holding her back was school. Work tied her down further as she became a teenager. All grown up, she has a career, a social life, family to care for, all the trappings of a mundane life. And yet, that spark of Glamour she inherited from her mother doesn't go out. It never will, even if it cools to an ember. The balancing act is more difficult for fully-grown Kinain than for any other in the world of the fae. In a way, it's something she's prepared herself for her entire life. Belonging wholly to both worlds — the exact opposite of her changeling family.

Kinain as Characters

The Kinain tend to act as a bridge between human and changeling society. A decent-sized freehold has two or three Kinain “on call” for situations too Banal for changelings to handle. They are, as a rule, expected to put their changeling “betters” above all else, and come to the aid of the freehold at the drop of a hat. Unless she's lucky enough to have a noble for a parent, the Kinain doesn't get a say in things. In emergencies, concessions can be made, and commoners are likely to understand if they can't get assistance right away, but woe be unto the fae-blooded that can't come when her Queen calls because she has a double shift at work that night. (Of course, in the modern era, even nobles understand enough about mundane life that they sympathize with a Kinain's situation. Some sidhe feel that even *acknowledging* non-fae concerns like employment and school is acquiescence to Banality, and refuse to do it lest they undermine their own authority. Kinain — and even Kithain — stuck in such a freehold have some difficult choices to make.)

Traditionalist Kithain often see Kinain as inherently lesser. Such thoughts lead to terrible things happening. A noble with strong views on the use of cantrips might forbid the education of Kinain in even the small amount of magic she can use, for reasons ranging from the political (a strong sense of who is and isn't fae) to arbitrary (personal distaste for the Kinain). Once again, the children of nobility are often exempt from these laws.

Even the most hardline traditionalist in the nobility is forced to admit that having a Kinain in her freehold is a wise choice. Dealing with the Autumn world means dealing with Banality, and it's much safer to have someone for whom that isn't an issue rather than risk the lives of one's dearest allies.

Perks aside, most fae-blooded adventure with changelings for the same reason anyone involved in the Dreaming does so: for fun, excitement, and to keep imagination alive in a world that wants to crush it. When one's options are sitting at home and watching TV, or slaying a dragon with a troll for the elf queen, it's not a difficult choice. Beyond any singularly selfish reasons, a motley offers friendship, companions, and family.

As for dealing with their families, the Kinain have it lucky. Sharing the world she lives in with her birth family is something so few changelings get to experience, while their children might never have to worry about such a thing. This may be one of the only logical reasons for Kithain prejudice towards the fae-blooded: mere jealousy. A solid majority of Kithain across every kith, every house, and both courts needs